

PROBLEMS OR OPPORTUNITIES?



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The important thing is to recognize that this country has no shortage of problems to be solved urgently. We have the largest number of children with malnutrition. We have the poorest public health service in the world. We have the dirtiest rivers in the world. Our vehicles produce the highest carbon per vehicle in the world. We have the lowest per-capita usable water in the world. Our primary education is one of the lowest quality in the world. I can go on and on. Any worthwhile contribution to the nation is only possible if you combine your competence with professionalism. Elders of our society – academicians, politicians, bureaucrats, corporate leaders and corporate leaders – must debate deeply (about the quality of research in India), and act urgently if we have to leave a better world for our children and grandchildren.

NARAYANA MURTHY

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point contact for the village with the outside world both in terms of information as well as communication. Tata Trusts, with its vast field based ecosystem, will manage the on-ground rollout with its partners, whereas Google will invest in providing the Internet-enabled Carts and the training content.

Similarly, efforts are underway in the southern Indian state of Karnataka to integrate the Public Distribution System to reduce and finally eliminate corruption and pilferage through the system. Through various pilot projects, Intel India in partnership with Karnataka state government, is rolling out electronic meters equipped with fingerprint sensors that

are connected to the central AADHAR database for authenticating identity of individuals when they come to claim subsidised food made available through their local ration store. Even if a poor, illiterate person who couldn't sign their name can now with just their thumb imprint can rightfully claim the food that they're entitled to, and traders can be held more accountable than ever, reducing damage of goods and pilferage to a great extent.

Both these initiatives are great examples of empowering people through technology and enriching their lives like never before. Technology is this conduit through which far-reaching change is possible. All we need to do is imagine the possibilities.

BUILD LOCAL PRODUCTS

Don't just stop importing products. Think of making them right here. So what if big companies have a head start? Think digital services. Think how to get things done better, more efficiently than anyone else. Companies such as Celkon, Karbonn Mobiles have already been manufacturing smartphones in the country, and recently Huawei has received the government's nod to setup a local manufacturing plant to serve the Indian market. One of China's and the world's biggest gadget manufacturer, Foxconn, is expected to set up a plant in Andhra Pradesh or Maharashtra to manufacture iPhones and other products right here in India. A tectonic shift

HOW CAN INDIAN COMPANIES MAKE WORLD CLASS TECH PRODUCTS?



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A beginning has been made with govt initiatives, in consultation with the private sector, with correct steps in the right direction. Ecosystem will develop i.e. starting with component manufacturing, to chipset and industrial design and finally finished goods, which has to be supported by simplified tax & government compliance. The success stories of companies that Make in China or USA is in large part thanks to their strength in the domestic market with either implicit or explicit support of local governments in both benefits for manufacturing (like tax breaks) as well as large purchase orders by the government for their own consumption from local companies. If a level playing field is available then the result would be world class products from local companies that any Indian would be proud of.

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